

Email & SMS Playbook

Templates, Sequences, and Strategies for
Marketing Channels That Convert at the Highest Rate

*Social media rents your audience. Email and SMS own it.
This playbook is your guide to channels you actually control.*

Why Email & SMS Still Win

With every algorithm change, social media reach drops. But email and SMS reach your audience directly - no algorithm, no pay-to-play. Email averages \$42 return for every \$1 spent. SMS open rates exceed 90%. No other channel comes close.

Email vs SMS - When to Use Each

Email: Longer content, education, nurture sequences, detailed offers, newsletters.

SMS: Time-sensitive offers, appointment reminders, flash sales, quick updates, re-engagement.

The most powerful brands use both. Email builds the relationship. SMS closes the loop.

Welcome Email Sequence (5 Emails)

The first 7 days after someone joins your list are the most important. This sequence sets the tone for the entire relationship.

Email 1 - Welcome (Immediate)

Subject: Welcome! Here is what happens next.

Hey [Name], welcome to [brand/community name]!

I am [Your Name], and I help [audience] [achieve result].

Here is what you can expect from me:

- [Value promise 1]*
- [Value promise 2]*
- [Value promise 3]*

Reply to this email and tell me: what is the #1 challenge you are facing with [topic] right now?

Talk soon, [Your Name]

Email 2 - Your Story (Day 2)

Subject: The moment everything changed for me

I want to tell you something I do not share often...

[Share a personal story about facing the same challenge your audience faces. Be specific. Be vulnerable. Show the before and the turning point.]

This is why I built [brand/product]. And it is why I am glad you are here.

[Your Name]

Email 3 - Value Drop (Day 3-4)

Subject: [Actionable tip or quick win - make it specific]

Today I want to give you something you can use immediately.

[Teach one concrete, actionable thing. Keep it focused. End with a transition toward your offer: 'If you want to go deeper on this, here is how I can help...']

[Your Name]

Email 4 - Social Proof (Day 5)

Subject: '[Client quote or result as subject line]'

[Name] reached out to me [timeframe] ago. They were dealing with [specific problem].

After [working together / using our product], here is what changed: [specific result].

Their words: '[Direct quote from client or customer]'

If you are in a similar place, here is what I recommend as a next step: [CTA]

Email 5 - The Offer (Day 6-7)

Subject: Ready for [specific result]? Here is how.

If you have been reading my emails this week, you know I care about [topic].

I want to make it easy for you to take the next step.

[Product/Service Name] is [one sentence description].

It includes: [3 bullet benefits]

Investment: \$[X]

[CTA button text]: [Link]

Questions? Just reply to this email. I answer every one.

Abandoned Cart Email Sequence (3 Emails)

Email 1 - Gentle Reminder (1 Hour After Abandonment)

Subject: Did something go wrong?

Hey [Name], I noticed you did not complete your order for [Product Name].

If anything went wrong - payment issue, question, or hesitation - I am here to help. Just reply to this email.

Your cart is saved: [Link to cart]

Email 2 - Value Reminder (24 Hours Later)

Subject: What you are getting with [Product Name]

Quick reminder of what is waiting for you:

[Bullet list of 3-5 benefits or what is included]

Hundreds of people have used [Product Name] to [achieve specific result].

Ready to continue? [Complete My Order - Link]

Email 3 - Final Push (48-72 Hours Later)

Subject: Last reminder (I will not bother you again)

This is my last email about your [Product Name] order.

If you are on the fence, here is the simplest way to think about it:

[Single compelling reason to buy - ROI, result, or risk reversal]

[Complete My Order - Link]

If this is not the right time, no worries. I will continue sending you value.

20 SMS Templates

Keep SMS under 160 characters when possible. Be direct. Include the offer and one link.

Promotional SMS Templates

1. [Brand]: [Product] is now live. Get it before [deadline]: [link]
2. Flash sale - 24 hours only. [X]% off [product]. Use code [CODE]: [link]
3. Last [X] spots available for [offer/event]. Grab yours: [link]
4. Hey [Name]! New [product/post/resource] just dropped. Check it out: [link]
5. [Brand]: Thank you for your order! Track it here: [link]

Engagement & Follow-Up SMS Templates

1. Hey [Name], quick question - did you get a chance to check out [resource]?
2. [Name], your consultation is in 1 hour. See you at [link/location].
3. Reminder: [Event/offer] ends tonight at midnight. Do not miss it: [link]
4. [Name], your order is ready for pickup / has shipped. Details: [link]
5. We miss you! Come back and [action] - here is [incentive]: [link]

Re-Engagement SMS Templates

1. Hey [Name], it has been a while. Here is something for you: [offer + link]
2. [Brand]: We updated [product/service]. Here is what is new: [link]
3. [Name], exclusive to our SMS list - [offer]: [link]. Expires [date].
4. Still interested in [topic/product]? We have something new for you: [link]
5. One thing I know about [Name]: [personalized compliment or insight]. Here is how to [next step]: [link]

Subject Line Formulas That Drive Opens

40% of emails are opened or ignored based on the subject line alone. These formulas consistently outperform generic lines.

Top-Performing Formulas

- The Curiosity Gap: 'I almost did not send this...' / 'You will not believe what happened'
- The Direct Benefit: 'How to [achieve result] in [timeframe]'
- The Question: 'Is [common belief] killing your [goal]?'
- The Number: '[X] things I use every day to [result]'
- The Personal: '[Name], this is specifically for you'
- The Urgency: 'Closing in [X] hours - do not miss this'
- The Controversial: 'Why I stopped [popular practice] forever'
- The Story: 'The worst mistake I ever made in [area]'

Test two subject lines every send. After 30 days, you will know exactly what your audience responds to.